

Speaker 1 [00:00:02] All right. Well, thank you, [Participant's Name], for joining us today and participating in the interview. As I mentioned over text, we just want to know a little bit more about your romantic views. And we think that your experiences and your perspective would bring a lot to our project. Before we begin, is it all right if we record this interview? We only use it for transcription slash note taking.

Speaker 2 [00:00:28] Yeah, that's that's cool with me.

Speaker 1 [00:00:31] Sounds good. All right. Start off. How old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:00:36] I am [21-25] years old.

Speaker 1 [00:00:39] And how long have you and your partner been together?

Speaker 2 [00:00:43] We have been dating for [1-5] years now.

Speaker 1 [00:00:45] [1-5] years? High school sweethearts?

Speaker 2 [00:00:49] Yep.

Speaker 1 [00:00:50] Do you have any children?

Speaker 2 [00:00:52] No.

Speaker 1 [00:00:54] And who lives in the household that you're in.

Speaker 2 [00:00:58] It's me, my girlfriend and my mom.

Speaker 1 [00:01:03] And what's your main source of income?

Speaker 2 [00:01:08] I work a 9 to 5 job.

Speaker 1 [00:01:13] What kind of job is it?

Speaker 2 [00:01:15] So I do, [occupation]. Specifically, I'm in charge of, the finishes on all of the projects we create.

Speaker 1 [00:01:28] That's cool. So. I'm [occupation].

Speaker 2 [00:01:33] Oh, you are.

Speaker 1 [00:01:35] [occupation]. Building it?

Speaker 2 [00:01:37] Yeah. Yeah, yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:01:39] And, how would you like us to address your partner? Girlfriend? Lover? Her name.

Speaker 2 [00:01:45] But girlfriend. Girlfriend works.

Speaker 1 [00:01:48] Okay. And can you tell me about your love story?

Speaker 2 [00:01:55] So. Well. We. We met in [class]. Started talking there. And then I remember I asked her to prom. I think from there it kind of just it turned into a relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:02:21] Yeah. So after prom, did, you guys started dating right away, or did you go, did you wait a little while?

Speaker 2 [00:02:28] No, it wasn't directly after prom. We actually, it was right after my birthday, which was, I think, a couple weeks after prom. And then I asked her out.

Speaker 1 [00:02:43] You asked her out on a date?

Speaker 2 [00:02:45] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:02:46] And where do you guys go? Would you do.

Speaker 2 [00:02:50] Our first day. I don't. Well, we had days before that. I kind of just asked her out, and we didn't. We didn't go on a date right then and there, but. I just asked her to be my girlfriend.

Speaker 1 [00:03:07] Okay, so after the first day, you end up like after like the first formal day, you end up asking to be your girlfriend official. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:03:16] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:03:18] And then you guys, like, went on more like dates every day. Or did you like, how did it kind of develop after you asked her out?

Speaker 2 [00:03:27] Yeah, well, we just started hanging out. We would go on little dates, do things like go to dinner, the movies, or just hang out, honestly. And then we kind of just built our relationship from there.

Speaker 1 [00:03:42] Very cute. So how would you compare the quality of your relationship compared to that of your friends relationship? And why do you think so?

Speaker 2 [00:03:56] And, any specific friend or just any, any of my friends.

Speaker 1 [00:04:01] Any of your friends. If you want to give a few examples, that would be helpful.

Speaker 2 [00:04:06] Well, honestly. I don't know. Too many of my friends have written in. Relationship over [1-5] years. So I, I would say, we're doing pretty well compared to some of my friends or most of my friends.

Speaker 1 [00:04:28] Yeah. Why do you think that your relationship lasted longer than theirs did?

Speaker 2 [00:04:35] Just, being truthful, being loyal, being honest, and, you know. Giving each other unconditional love. You know, it's it's not always going to be, you know, perfect and sunshine and rainbows all the time, you know, is there's going to be moments where it's it's hard, but, you know, it's about working through those, those hardships and ultimately that'll make you stronger as a couple, I believe. And I think that's what you know, has. Helped us continue our relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:05:14] Right. So you think like you because you and your girlfriend got through, like the hardships that it, like, made your relationship longer, and then your friends couldn't, like, get through those hardships.

Speaker 2 [00:05:28] Yeah, well, I think, you know, it's just like some most of my friends, you know, it's. When they come across something that's, you know, kind of hard for them in their relationship. It's like, okay, well, that's a deal breaker. And then they'll just end up, you know, splitting, splitting apart. But you know, if you truly love someone, you know, you gotta your emotions are going to be high in the moment and maybe you feel some a certain way, but you got to remember why you love that person. And then, you know, just try and work, work out that problem with them. You know? I think that will ultimately make the relationship stronger.

Speaker 1 [00:06:13] Yeah, 100% agree with that. So can you. Can I also ask how many romantic partners you've had in the past?

Speaker 2 [00:06:25] Zero. She's my my only girlfriend that I've ever had.

Speaker 1 [00:06:30] Okay. And well do you have you had like, let's say, a relationship, a romantic relationship that hasn't been a girlfriend, like, in any capacity.

Speaker 2 [00:06:44] No. Not really. In high school, I was I was pretty to myself in high school, so I. I don't really have any romantic relationships. And I mean, she she was my first, so.

Speaker 1 [00:06:56] Okay. And so this question I'm probably gonna have to worded a little differently. But did you ever have, like, any feelings or any, like, crushes on girls throughout before her?

Speaker 2 [00:07:10] Yeah, sure. I mean, in high school, I was I was young, and, you know, I had never really experienced love. And I was curious. So of course, I had crushes on. On different girls, but I never pursued them, obviously. I was too scared and nervous.

Speaker 1 [00:07:27] Okay, so how how would you compare yourself with those type of girls to compare it to those type of girls with, like how you are with your girlfriend, if that made sense.

Speaker 2 [00:07:43] So you think like.

Speaker 1 [00:07:45] Like what made it? What made it with your girlfriend like different? That you did feel more confident to be with her and like, why did it.

Speaker 2 [00:07:54] Was more.

Speaker 1 [00:07:55] Or more than, say, your previous, people that you liked?

Speaker 2 [00:08:01] It was more natural. It was just, you know, some connected, some clicked is, you know, I could talk to her, you know, with the other people that, you know, I had crushes on, I, I don't, I just. They were never really. I never really approached them because I was too nervous. But I don't know, something with [Name]. It just it was easy for

me to approach her and and she was in my class and we just started talking, and I think that's what made it so easy.

Speaker 1 [00:08:37] Yeah. So you felt just, like, a lot more comfortable with her than. Yeah. Other would you say it was because of her, or was it because, like, you were, like, older and more confident? And, it was.

Speaker 2 [00:08:52] Probably a little bit of both. Honestly, you know, I mean, I was still in high school at the end of the senior year. I guess I grew a little bit more confident. I had lost a little weight, so I'm sure that helped a little bit. But you know, just being. Talking to her first was like, you know, I it wasn't like we were jumping into a relationship right away. And so it was just being able to talk to her in class and then building, you know, a friendship that turned into, you know, a relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:09:32] Okay. Do you think that helped with you feeling comfortable with her by starting as a friend before, like developing feelings for her?

Speaker 2 [00:09:42] I definitely think that helped. Yeah. Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:09:46] And, for you, what makes a relationship high quality and what makes one a low quality?

Speaker 2 [00:09:58] So high quality. You know, it's like I was kind of talking about earlier. It's. Being able to work. Through. You know. The serious and the hard moments in a relationship, you know, and then always being there for one another. Staying loyal, staying truthful, staying honest. Think that you know what kind of mix a high quality relationship is. Being able to know that this person got your back and that you have their back and. A local, low quality relationship for me. I don't know, honestly, because I would consider this relationship to be pretty high quality and I've never really. Had an experience with a low quality relationship. So. But if I had to think of it, it would just be a relationship that's based around the. But, I guess you could say sex. I mean, just basing your relationship around that. And that's the only reason you're together. It's just, you know. Having sex or. Yeah, pretty much that. You know, not really wanting to be in a relationship with this person, but just more for the. For the use of sex.

Speaker 1 [00:11:39] Yeah. So more like we say, low quality is more when in the, let's say a relationship is focused on physical intimacy and not, like both like physical and, emotional emotional. Thank you. I was like, thank you.

Speaker 2 [00:11:55] You know? So yeah. It's great. Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:12:00] And, when would you say your relationship was, you know, like the most I don't want to say the most loyal because you guys always seemed like you guys always have been loyal. But what was your relationship like? The highest quality and the way you described it.

Speaker 2 [00:12:26] I'd say from now. Honestly.

Speaker 1 [00:12:29] No. And what you say would be the really.

Speaker 2 [00:12:37] Not when we first started dating, but maybe like. A year into when we started dating, because that's when, you know, like I was talking about going through

hardships and stuff. You know, we started to do that for the first time. And then like, I, I'm really been through this with this person. So, like, you're treading waters with certain things and emotions are running high. And that's probably, I would say when it was the lowest quality.

Speaker 1 [00:13:08] Right. One's like a little more like, unsure. And you kind of. Yeah. Oh. What are each other once out of each other?

Speaker 2 [00:13:17] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:13:20] So can you tell me more about how one knows that they're in more of an emotional intimacy relationship rather than a physical intimacy?

Speaker 2 [00:13:38] Let me think. Well, you know, it's. It. It's about both, you know. Partners being emotionally available. I think if you can. If you're in a relationship and. You know you can. Sorry, I'm kind of. Trying to think here.

Speaker 1 [00:14:12] These are challenging questions.

Speaker 2 [00:14:14] Yeah I know.

Speaker 1 [00:14:19] Maybe if I, like, rephrase it to make it sound simpler. How does. How does one know that? How does one know that they're in a relationship that's based more off emotional than just about sex?

Speaker 2 [00:14:37] I think it's it's simply that when it's just like, it seems like maybe one partner is. Only, you know, wanting sex and, you know, not really being emotionally available for the other partner. Okay. You. Sorry. Go ahead. No, actually, like, you know, if. If one partner is going through something that's, impactful in their life and they turn to the other partner for comfort or, you know, security, and that partner is just simply not available emotionally for them. And it doesn't seem like they're trying to put any effort in that way. As far as being supportive and Trying to comfort and make the other other partner feel better compared to, you know. You know, the other partner probably just always just like, okay, maybe. Maybe, maybe they'll show a little bit of emotional support, but it's not really to the extent of. And then, you know, they just. That's what I would say is. More of, like, an emotionally, intimate relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:16:01] Yeah. So they're just, like, more there for them if, if, when something goes wrong or even in, say, the other way, if something goes right, you know. Yeah. Courting them and like happy for them and being like, let's just have sex. Yeah okay. See? There you go. That was a good answer. So for you, what are the most important things in a relationship? I know we kind of touched based on it, but I kind of want to go back little deeper. What's the most important things in our relationship, and why would you say so?

Speaker 2 [00:16:40] Honesty. Just being honest with your feelings and how you want your partner. To treat you and your emotions. I think that's very important. You know. If it's. You know, if they're not being there for you or, you know, not being honest with you, you're not being truthful, you're not being loyal. And I think that's just kind of a deal breaker in a relationship. And it's like, how how are you supposed to grow as a couple if you don't have those things?

Speaker 1 [00:17:21] And why do you think like those are more important than things like, like sex or like other, other qualities of a relationship? Why do you why do you say those are the most important?

Speaker 2 [00:17:33] Well, I think sex and all, that's still very important, I just think. As far as honesty goes, it's. That really builds your relationship with your partner and you know, it builds that trust. It builds that that bond between each other, you know, and it's not, you know, the other partner won't always be worrying about what this person is doing or, you know, can I trust him to, you know, provide for me? Can I trust him to, you know, make me feel secure? And, you know, maybe if we want to start a family, you know, is this someone that I can rely on, that I can trust to, you know, nurture, care for a child? Yeah, I think that's that's why.

Speaker 1 [00:18:25] Okay. Yeah. So just like the qualities, like we'll implement, like a solid future and.

Speaker 2 [00:18:33] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:18:34] Yeah. Trust a trust in that person to, like, be good for you in the future. Not just today.

Speaker 2 [00:18:41] Yeah. Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:18:43] And for you, what is love?

Speaker 2 [00:18:52] I think love is a lot of things. It's. It's. Kind of everything that we've been talking about, it's it's sex. It's it's truth, truthfulness. It's being intimate emotionally also physically. And it's truly I guess. That unconditional love, you know, is really caring for a person. No [Participant's Name]er no [Participant's Name]er what the circumstances are, you know? It's being able to love a person at their lowest and love a person at their highest. You know, that love is constant and doesn't change.

Speaker 1 [00:19:43] Okay. And how important is love in a relationship? If you. You can actually, I'll answer ask follow up questions. But how important is love in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:19:57] Well, I think love makes what type of relationship you're having. I mean, you can have relationships without love, and those aren't necessarily intimate relationships. Those could be friendships. Those could be, you know, business partners, bosses, you know, different types of relationships. But when you bring love into it, it's. You know, it's more intimate love. It could be a family member. It can be a friend. But, you know, depending on the strength of the love, it could be a partner.

Speaker 1 [00:20:30] So if you had to like rank between. So before you said things like, qualities in a relationship like, loyalty and sex and being like, not just caring about sex, but sex is also important. How would you put love if you had to rank it, like from a number one being the most important? Down. Like to.

Speaker 2 [00:20:55] The.

Speaker 1 [00:20:56] Most important third.

Speaker 2 [00:20:57] As far as any relationship or more, like, a partner.

Speaker 1 [00:21:03] You could go both ways if you want to explain what you think it is. In both.

Speaker 2 [00:21:06] Ways. I think, if you know. I think love is important. Honestly, in all relationships, it is because if you're willing to have a relationship with someone, you have to. Be able to maybe not love them, but like them to a certain extent. But you know, if the love is deeper than I and it becomes more of an intimate relationship, then I think love is very important.

Speaker 1 [00:21:40] So an intimate relationship, how would you rank it from one being the most important to. Like, say, three being least important.

Speaker 2 [00:21:53] Well, let's say from a scale from 1 to 10, I would I'd give it a ten. Ten. Intimate relation. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:21:59] Okay. So you would put, is more important than loyalty and say, like sex or.

Speaker 2 [00:22:08] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:22:09] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:22:10] Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:22:12] And how do you know that your partner loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:22:25] I don't know. There's. There's a feeling, you know, there's obviously there's a certain energy that you get from a person that you can kind of tell if. They're being fake or they truly love you. I guess it's. That's hard to explain. You know how to tell if a person really loves you. There's a lot of factors that go into it, but. I would say number one would just be the. They. They're emotional. Emotionally available for you? I would say. If I.

Speaker 1 [00:23:07] Am. Oh, sorry. Go ahead.

Speaker 2 [00:23:13] You know, it's it's like. It's like the feeling you would get from, let's say, your mom, you know, let's say you're going through something. Pretty, pretty hard. And. You know, you turn to your mom for that. That comfort, that, you know, advice. And you can kind of feel motherly love. I would say, you know, it's a similar it's a similar energy that you can kind of feel from a person. And that would. Go ahead.

Speaker 1 [00:23:50] And you feel like the. Well, yeah, come for it. I had another word, but you can continue.

Speaker 2 [00:23:57] Oh yeah. That's that's what I would say. That's to know, like, if a person truly loves you, it's like, are they caring for you or are they there for you if you're going through something or if you've achieved something, if, you know, are they there for you or are they just, you know. If they're not, you know. You would be able to feel that, you know. It's like it's like if you were to go to them and say, hey, you know, like, I'm experience experiencing a loss in my family. We would say, you know, one of my siblings

passed away and you go to them and you, you kind of are seeking comfort and you would be able to tell immediately if they're going to be emotionally available for you.

Speaker 1 [00:24:44] Is it like things that she says or like action that she does?

Speaker 2 [00:24:50] It's both actions and, you know, things that she says, like, okay, you know, like, let's say I that did happen and I lost a family member and I go to her seeking, you know, like, I'm dad, you know, and I'm seeking comfort. You know, is she going to just be like, oh, you know. I'm sorry. And then, you know, go about her day or is she going to be continuing continuously trying to, you know, reassure me that everything's going to be okay and like, hey, can I get you anything or let's go, let's go do this to try and take your mind off a bit, stuff like that.

Speaker 1 [00:25:28] Okay. And, what would you say are challenges in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:25:43] I guess we're still pretty young, so. I want to say there's there's a lot we still have to learn. Obviously, I'm not saying we're the perfect couple. But some challenges, I would say, you know, financially. That can play a big factor. Especially, you know, being in my situation, I want to be able to get a house or get a place for us, you know, and that, you know, really move on in our relationship and. Kind of take it to the next, the next stage. And that's hard financially. Right now. Some other things I don't. Let me think. I.

Speaker 1 [00:26:34] It can be little or big. Whatever you think.

Speaker 2 [00:26:49] I can't really think of any right now.

Speaker 1 [00:26:52] Okay, let me ask. Who do you guys fight?

Speaker 2 [00:27:00] Have? Yeah, we have our arguments. I guess that that could be something. But again, it's. What I find helps is, you know, if we do get into an argument, I. I'd like to give her her space and. Kind of let our emotions run and then calm down and then kind of reconnect and say, hey, okay, look, we. We had an argument. You know. I'm sorry. She's sorry. And, you know, we talk about. What went wrong and how we can work on it and then, you know, build from there.

Speaker 1 [00:27:39] And how would you say, like how often were these fights? Or are those.

Speaker 2 [00:27:44] Fights? You know, they happen every now and then. It's it's not it's not a constant or a reoccurring thing, you know.

Speaker 1 [00:27:55] Like if you had to go, like, based off, like, once a week, every other week, once a month, how how would you scale up?

Speaker 2 [00:28:03] Probably once a month.

Speaker 1 [00:28:05] Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:28:06] So you know, and the, the, the level of the argument depends. It could be a small, you know, little tiny thing or it could be big, but. So far we've worked through awful.

Speaker 1 [00:28:19] Okay. We're not in ten minutes, so I don't know why zoom does this, but it's like making you upgrade to go past 40 minutes.

Speaker 2 [00:28:27] So we're supposed to be.

Speaker 1 [00:28:30] Well, we're like. Was because I had it up running before.

Speaker 2 [00:28:36] On.

Speaker 1 [00:28:37] Like it's only been.

Speaker 2 [00:28:38] Oh, I see.

Speaker 1 [00:28:39] But we're like close to half like more than halfway done like I have like it's not gonna I'm not gonna have time in probably 20 more minutes, but okay. It's just going to stop and then I'm gonna end it and I'll send you another link. Sorry.

Speaker 2 [00:28:58] Okay. I didn't know if I.

Speaker 1 [00:28:59] Started doing this. I think this is a new thing. Never did.

Speaker 2 [00:29:03] So it's fine.

Speaker 1 [00:29:04] Okay. So I'll get you and answer a few more questions on this one.

Speaker 2 [00:29:09] And.

Speaker 1 [00:29:10] Sorry for the interruption, but, so, like, what are the the fights I you have, what are they usually about?

Speaker 2 [00:29:23] Be anything from, you know, cleaning and you know. Money or just certain finances and or it could be something, you know, it's like, hey. What? I don't know. You know, I can't really think about most the most of the ones that we've had. They've been just little things, like cleaning or money or, you know, maybe certain family members in the family that just. That we don't get along with. I can give you an example. My aunt, she's kind of. She's a clean freak. And she's always over here, and she'll just show. Sometimes she'll say stuff to [Name], and it's just. It's really annoying. And it can be. Could be hard, but, you know, we work through that.

Speaker 1 [00:30:30] Yeah. And she just, like, make the comments just to her to like both of you guys.

Speaker 2 [00:30:37] It's both of us. But sometimes it feels like. Targeted towards [Name] and, I, you know, I've talked to my hand and I'm like, hey, like, you need to. You need to back off like this. This isn't cool. And obviously, sometimes it just doesn't sit right with [Name]. And, you know, she takes offense to it, and I understand that's totally fine. And then. But, you know, we we talk about it and we talk over it and we we work through it. Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:31:09] So you said, when you said the way you resolve your fights, you know, just giving her time and then talking through her once, you know, things are cooled down. So what are other ways that you to maintain your relationship other than that?

Speaker 2 [00:31:25] Wait. Can you say it again?

Speaker 1 [00:31:27] Yeah. So, when you said, like, when you resolve your conflict, you, like, give her space and time, and then you end up talking about it. What are like other ways that you can maintain your relationship, like when you guys are maybe going through something or just in general.

Speaker 2 [00:31:52] Honestly, sometimes food helps. I'll go and get her food or, you know, I'll, ask her if she's hungry. Yeah, I'll get her food or something, but. Like, would you? Are you asking like other ways like resolve and argument.

Speaker 1 [00:32:12] Knowledges, other ways you maintain relationships. So say like, like that's a good way of like you go get her food or like. I don't know, stuff like that.

Speaker 2 [00:32:25] Yeah, well, I'll do that. Or, you know. Maybe she wants some things she's been talking about. I'll get her that, you know, and try and just be like, hey, like, I know we had an argument, but I still love you. Here's this. You know, obviously, you know, just talking about our issues. Talking about our problems. That's probably number one. Other ways. I would say. Yeah. Really? Really. Just talking it over, you know? I'm talking about whatever the issue is.

Speaker 1 [00:33:09] Okay, so I'm going to stop it now before because I don't want the next like questions to cut you off. And anyway.

Speaker 2 [00:33:16] So.

Speaker 1 [00:00:00] Now.

Speaker 2 [00:00:02] All right. So would you say the relationship is good for you? And why would you say so?

Speaker 1 [00:00:09] Yeah, I, I think it's it's, it's definitely built. My character is definitely, you know. Being that this is my first relationship. Help me, you know, understand more about a woman and how they act and how to deal with them emotionally. You know, compared to when I first started dating her, I sometimes, you know, I could be a little aggressive. Verbally. And, you know, when I would get mad and I kind of understand now that that that doesn't work, and it just leads to more chaos and more disruption in the relationship. So I would say, yeah, it's it's definitely help me understand. More about how to treat a woman and also more about myself, you know, and what I want. To be as a man.

Speaker 2 [00:01:15] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:01:15] Being able. Being able to provide being able to, you know. Make her feel secure and loved.

Speaker 2 [00:01:29] And. So a lot of the times that this interview mentioned that, like, you feel like supported by her and that she's like, there for you, but what about like from day to

day, you know, situations. Is there any example of, like, why you'd say the relationship is good for you on like day to day? Aspects.

Speaker 1 [00:01:51] Okay. Yeah. I mean, a certain time, like if I'm coming home from work and it's a frustrating day. It's always nice to come home and see her and, you know, you know, be able to talk to her about my day and hear about her day. You know. That really helps because, you know, obviously she's she listens to me and my problems more throughout the day. You know, if I didn't have the, you know, I just kind of would bottle that up, I wouldn't be able to talk to anybody. And, you know, probably it would make me angry. It would make me frustrated. You know, I don't know where that frustration would. Turn out. So like, you know, it is really helpful as far as like a day to day basis example, I would say, yeah, you know, just being able to come home and talk to.

Speaker 2 [00:02:51] Yeah. So I was, I was listening, I was just saving, this loss, reporting, you know, this. Yeah. So you, like, think it was like, from day to day, this kind of regulator, she regulated her emotions just by being able to open up to somebody to talk to.

Speaker 1 [00:03:09] Yeah. And I, you know, I look forward to coming home and seeing her and spending time with her, you know, watching the movie or going out to dinner, eating food, cooking, whatever that may be.

Speaker 2 [00:03:22] Yeah. So even, like after a hard day, you come home and it just makes your day better just to to be with her.

Speaker 1 [00:03:30] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:03:32] Undo. Did the relationship change you?

Speaker 1 [00:03:40] I would say so, yes. You know, before I kind of. I got into a relationship there. You know, I had a, a period kind of towards the end of high school where I was, I was dealing with a lot of anxiety and depression and. I really didn't know why I was feeling that way. Part of me thinks it's because, you know, like, I was kind of going into the next stage of life. You know, after high school. And I think I was scared because I didn't know what I was going to do or how I was going to do it. And then, you know, I kind of got into when I got into the relationship a couple of years down the line, I'm like, okay, you know, now I'm really just. Just focused on, you know, bettering myself physically, mentally, you know, emotionally, spiritually and trying to be the best person I can for her. And also, you know, it it's like a drive. You know, she creates a drive in me to, you know, want to give her a better life. So I'm constantly trying to figure out, you know, how I'm and I'm going to, you know, make more money or. You know, be able to get her to a place where she's secure and she doesn't have to worry about working or anything like that.

Speaker 2 [00:05:02] Okay. Yeah. So she, like, kind of changed. Not even changed, but kind of, like, created a new path for you that you like. Didn't really expect.

Speaker 1 [00:05:13] Yeah. Because. Yeah. Before her, like I said, you know, coming out of high school, I was kind of I was lost, honestly, I didn't know what what I was going to do, and. She kind of. Yeah. Paved the path for me. Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:05:30] And what about your girlfriend? Did they change during the relationship?

Speaker 1 [00:05:38] Yeah, definitely. You know, I remember we used to. Always be doing something, going out, hanging out with friends and stuff. But you know, obviously we've we've gone through stuff with family and everything. So that's definitely made an impact, on both of our lives. But, you know, I would say she's. She hasn't changed too much. She's she's still the same as when I met her. But, I mean, she's just a lot more mature.

Speaker 2 [00:06:18] And do you think that's because of you? Or what do you think? Why do you think that she's more mature?

Speaker 1 [00:06:24] I would maybe contribute some of, you know, some of it to me, but not all of it. I think she's learned a lot on her own just from her experiences. I would say she's. Definitely changed me than I changed. More of the night changer.

Speaker 2 [00:06:42] Okay. Do you feel safe in the relationship? Why do you say so? You could give, like, concrete examples.

Speaker 1 [00:06:58] Yeah. Safe. As in like. What do you mean by safe?

Speaker 2 [00:07:03] So say, it can be physical or emotional or both, or just in general. To sway any I see.

Speaker 1 [00:07:12] Yeah, more emotionally, I definitely feel safe because I can trust her, to be honest. She's always. She always tells me the truth. And you know what's going on with her. And, you know, I like that, you know, and that kind of built that, that trust with us. And, you know, I don't ever worry about, where she is or what she's doing. I trust her to, you know, be honest with me. Obviously, I worry about her, you know, if anything happen is happening to her, you know, if she's going out or something and she's at the bar or hanging out with their friends. Obviously, I worry for her safety, but I never worry about what she's doing, you know? And that's kind of that's really, you know, nice to have is trust that truthfulness and that trust trustworthiness.

Speaker 2 [00:08:08] Right. That's like before you said how like your relationship was like, really built on, like, trust and, you know, like, not just like physical trust of where she's going, but like, emotional trust, too.

Speaker 1 [00:08:22] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:08:23] And. We're almost done. Bear with me. Okay, so I'm going to give you a little visual aid, okay. These questions.

Speaker 1 [00:08:42] Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:08:51] Can you see my screen?

Speaker 1 [00:08:53] Yes I can.

Speaker 2 [00:08:54] Awesome show. All right. Well. All right, so the statement my partner usually really listens to me. How would you rank that from one? Not true at all. To completely true. If you said that statement.

Speaker 1 [00:09:14] Seven.

Speaker 2 [00:09:16] Seven. Very true. Okay. And then what about the statement? My partner usually is responsive to my needs. How would you rank it from 1 to 10?

Speaker 1 [00:09:28] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:09:32] And then how satisfied are you with your relationship? I'm completely dissatisfied. Two. Completely satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:09:44] Completely satisfied.

Speaker 2 [00:09:47] And on a number of scale, how would you rate your, satisfaction with your relationship from zero? Not at all. Satisfied to ten. Completely satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:10:01] How would you rate yourself?

Speaker 2 [00:10:03] Oh, sorry, I can do that.

Speaker 1 [00:10:04] I'll put, you can do ten.

Speaker 2 [00:10:07] Ten. Completely satisfied?

Speaker 1 [00:10:09] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:10:11] This doesn't apply to you and that doesn't apply to you either. Okay, awesome. We're done with that.

Speaker 1 [00:10:18] Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:10:20] So I got some follow up questions with that one. So. When I asked. My partner usually is responsive to my needs. You said a seven. Very true. Why did you answer seven? Could you give me an example of when you felt like she really listened to you?

Speaker 1 [00:10:46] Yeah. Maybe. Maybe [1-5] year or so back. I remember I was having some conversations with my dad who hasn't, you know, necessarily been the best father. He's in my life, but not to the extent that I would like him to be. And, it took me a long time to realize, you know. How impactful he was in my life and how impactful it was for me as a man and him not being here. And she is very, very helpful with, you know, reassuring me that, you know, I am the person that I am today. Because of that. And I should be proud of that because, you know. It kind of kind of shaped me into more of a man. With him not being here because, you know, I didn't. I had to learn everything my own as far as being, I would say, masculine and being a. A male figure in society. Because. Before. When I was younger, I looked at my dad and even though he wasn't there all the time, I still looked at him as like the the greatest dad in the world. And now that I'm older, I kind of realized like, hey, you know. Maybe he wasn't the greatest dad in the world. I still love him. I still think he's the best dad that he could have been. But now that I'm older, I kind of realize his flaws and where he messed up. And. I think. If it weren't for that, I wouldn't have the views that I have now. And you know I wouldn't. I want to be as comfortable, with the person that I am today. If you know he wasn't there. But she the. Back to the question. I kind of went off on a tangent there, but yeah, she was just very supportive during that that moment. You

know, it was very hard for me and. You know, she was always listening, always comforting during that, that period.

Speaker 2 [00:13:12] Yeah, no, that's definitely really tough. I'm glad that she was there for you to get through all that. Yeah. Especially, like looking, looking at it on a brighter side then on such a, like, a bad side. Yeah, that's really good. Nice answer for that one. And, when I. Did I say really listens to me, right? That was the first one.

Speaker 1 [00:13:48] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:13:48] Okay. So when I ask, my partners usually is responsive to my needs. You gave us seven. Very true. Why? Why would you say it? Very true. Could you give me an example of when she has been responsive to your needs?

Speaker 1 [00:14:16] That's kind of like a similar, similar statement to the previous one. So it's like, well.

Speaker 2 [00:14:30] That's what I feel like, did I ask? Last time? My partners usually responds to my needs.

Speaker 1 [00:14:36] No, no you didn't. I just feel like those questions are pretty. Along the same lines. They're pretty smart. Let me think. I guess it could just go back to, you know, being supportive with, all the choices that I make and, you know, decisions that I make in my life and her just being supportive of them. You know, as far as. You know, working or, you know, not going to school and, then just working or, you know, changing jobs. Or just, you know, little, little decisions that I make. And she's. She's like, you know. Yeah, that's what you want. And I think that's what you should do. And you know, I trust you to make the right decisions in your life to ultimately better us.

Speaker 2 [00:15:43] Okay. And why would you? Why would you say that is very true and not completely true? As there have been times where she has not been responsive to your needs or has not really listened to you.

Speaker 1 [00:16:00] Yeah, but usually those are in times of like arguments or, you know. Just certain times I would say, you know, these past this past year has definitely been very emotional for her, with her family and, obviously, you know, things she say, I don't I don't hold against her because I know she's going through a rough time, but. Maybe there's been a lack of. Being responsive to my needs during this time. But, you know, I completely understand that she's going through something herself that's, you know, very hard and much harder than what I'm going through. So that's that's why I would say that, but.

Speaker 2 [00:16:57] Yeah. So like, because, what she's going through, it's, like, harder to kind of like. Put you, like put your needs first above hers. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:17:10] That's like yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:17:12] Of you guys. What she's going through is like way more difficult.

Speaker 1 [00:17:16] Exactly.

Speaker 2 [00:17:18] That makes a lot of sense. Yeah. All right. We're almost wrapping up here. So I hope you don't mind us. And feel free to say this is too sensitive for you to

share, but we just want to know a little bit more about your physical intimacy as a couple. And so how often do you guys have sex these days?

Speaker 1 [00:17:43] Definitely not as much as we used to. When we first started dating, but. We. I would say, you know. Maybe four times a month. It's. Yeah. I mean, like I said, I don't we're not we don't base our relationship around it. But. Yeah, well, I would say about four times a month.

Speaker 2 [00:18:24] Okay. And, how satisfied are you with your sex life? And why do you say so?

Speaker 1 [00:18:34] I'm pretty satisfied. It's good. I. Yeah, I don't know. His goodness. That's all I could say about it, really. I mean, it's not I don't want to get into too much detail about it.

Speaker 2 [00:18:50] But I have no problem. Definitely I don't have to. So when I asked about how how satisfied you are with your relationship just in general, you said slightly satisfied and. Why did you say? I think you gave it ten, Like, completely.

Speaker 1 [00:19:15] Yeah. Again.

Speaker 2 [00:19:15] Satisfied? Why would. Why do you answer a ten?

Speaker 1 [00:19:22] Just because, you know, like I. I don't mean mean to like compare. Relationships, but I, I see some of my other friends relationships and just. You know, some of them have failed. And I like to think that, you know. I'm satisfied because we've we've come this far. And you know, I know we've we haven't always been perfect, but yet we still love each other and we still are, you know, together. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:20:03] Your satisfaction is more based off, like, how strong your guys's relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:20:08] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:20:09] Okay. And did the relationship fulfill your expectations?

Speaker 1 [00:20:15] Yeah, absolutely. Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:20:18] Well, we are officially done. I'm just.

Speaker 1 [00:20:23] Going to. Right here.

Speaker 2 [00:20:25] I know it's a long one, but. Yeah, really good answer. So that's what makes it longer when you have, like, really good answers. And I can't keep digging at you, you know.

Speaker 1 [00:20:34] No. Well, I tried to put as much effort as I could.

Speaker 2 [00:20:38] Definitely put 100% effort. And we will be very excited to read about or, you know, the research team will be excited to read about this.

Speaker 1 [00:20:47] All righty.

Speaker 2 [00:20:49] So I just kind of want to summarize what we have conversating about in the past like hour. So basically so like pretty much high school sweethearts at this point. And yeah, you know like you guys have a really strong relationship. You guys lasted [1-5] years, which is freaking awesome, especially compared to that of your friends. Definitely did not last very long, but, yeah. But yeah, your relationship seems like it's based on, like, a lot of loyalty and like, a lot of emotional support between both of you. And you have minimal problems and obviously, like young people, problems of finance and.

Speaker 1 [00:21:31] Yeah, obviously.

Speaker 2 [00:21:33] Yeah I'm like that I think everybody and yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:21:37] No it's that's that's yeah everybody kind of has to go through that.

Speaker 2 [00:21:42] Yeah. Yeah I mean that's how you get on top is you go through the, you go through the poor phase. And then when you get to the rich phase, you're like, I'm never going back. And then that's how I. Yep.

Speaker 1 [00:21:54] Yep.

Speaker 2 [00:21:54] So you guys, are you guys just seem like you build your relationship so much on emotional support, loving each other and loyalty, which is awesome. And now you're just working on building your future together, getting a house, maybe children and, yeah. Is there anything else you want to add? Was that right?

Speaker 1 [00:22:20] No. That was that was good. Sorry. She just walked in here and she's freaking laughing at me, right? Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:22:25] I know, sorry to say for so long. All right. So before we and also I want to just like tell you a little bit how we're going to handle the data. So I'm just a few I haven't sent it yet. And my bad. But I'm will send you. It's basically you're just going to sign a doc saying that you consent and agreed to having this happen and like, participating in this. But there's two options to it. One option is going to be the transcript portion can be shared. None of. So I'm just going to kind of sum it up. So the first option is basically going to be like. It's going to have the transcript. But like your name isn't going to be used and like, nothing gonna be like, able to like, nobody's gonna be able to identify you through the transcript.

Speaker 1 [00:23:17] Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:23:18] But, they're also going to be read by the researchers. So it's more it's I would say it's way more confidential than the second option. It's just more like the whole transcript could be read and any, like, overly sensitive information, like your name or, say, like where you live. We were cheated. But that, like, would be removed and, or that would be removed, but like everything else in the transcript would be there. There is minimal chance that somebody that, you know, can piece down and narrow down that it's you. So say, like you give it to your give the article. And then when we finish it, you give the article to your mom. She might be able to like kind of be like, oh, that might be his answer. That's kind of what it's saying. But, no sensitive information like your name or anything right now. So do you wanna do option one or option two? I'll send it to you.

Speaker 1 [00:24:24] To review it. Yeah, I think option two would be fine.

Speaker 2 [00:24:28] Okay. And I mean, I will send you guys once, like, this whole research thing is done. I will send you guys the article if you guys want to like read it and see what how you guys participated in it would look like.

Speaker 1 [00:24:43] But okay. Yeah, that'd be cool.

Speaker 2 [00:24:45] Yeah. It's just going to be your option though if you want to share it with anybody else.

Speaker 1 [00:24:50] So yeah, if you want to send it to me, I'd like to just read it. It'd be cool. Just want to see what interesting you.

Speaker 2 [00:24:57] So they also want us to tell you that it's also being. This study is being done in the Philippines, Brazil, Netherlands, France and in the US.

Speaker 1 [00:25:07] So okay.

Speaker 2 [00:25:08] Yeah. You're going to like once you read the article is going to like show you all the cultural differences and how like people like handle relationships differently. Differently.

Speaker 1 [00:25:18] Okay. Actually, yeah. That'll be cool.

Speaker 2 [00:25:21] Yeah, it might take a while, but I will definitely send that you guys.

Speaker 1 [00:25:25] And then.

Speaker 2 [00:25:28] I think this is it. All right, we are done. Thank you so very much.

Speaker 1 [00:25:35] Of course.